

HOUSE OF AYURVEDA - BATCH #173

Production Bible

Three Days Off The Multivitamin (Story VSL)

Analysis, locks, grade arc, prompt blocks, flow system

Document 1 of 5

Avatar Supplement Graveyard · Solution-Aware

Format Story VSL · ~5:45 · 9:16 vertical · zero lip-sync

Stack Nano Banana Pro / GPT Image → image-to-video

Branch claude/ayurveda-batch-173-vsl-fb061b

Production Bible — read this before you generate a single frame

House of Ayurveda · Avatar: Supplement Graveyard · Solution-Aware · ~5:45 · 9:16 vertical Zero lip-sync. She is never talking to camera. Everything is observational b-roll under VO.

PART 0 — What this script is actually doing

Before the shot list, the read. If you generate against the words instead of the mechanism, you get 80 pretty frames that don't sell anything.

The script is not about supplements. It's about eight years of being obedient to something that wasn't working, and the accident that gave her permission to stop. That's the emotional engine. Every visual choice below serves one of six jobs:

Block	Job it does	What the picture must make the viewer feel
Hook (0:00–0:20)	Pattern-interrupt + full-arc preview	"That's my counter." Recognition, then curiosity about the accident.
Problem (0:20–1:15)	Build the graveyard, then make it <i>cost something</i>	Accumulation → shame. The husband beat is the real hook, not the bottles.
Accident (1:15–2:00)	Re-hook. Remove her agency so she can't be blamed	Relief that she didn't <i>choose</i> to quit — it happened to her.
Labels (2:00–2:50)	Invalidate the old solution with a specific, checkable mechanism	"Wait, is mine magnesium oxide?" — the viewer gets up and checks.
Water + Copper (2:50–3:30)	Move the villain from the pills to the water. New category.	"I never thought about what I'm drinking it down with."
Cert (3:30–4:10)	De-risk. Make the claim verifiable, not asserted	Skepticism defused by physical proof they can replicate.
Transformation (4:10–5:00)	Pay off in <i>relational</i> terms, not symptom terms	The husband line is the close. Not sleep — being fun to be married to again.
Close (5:00–5:45)	Micro-commitment, no price, hand off to Page 1	"I should at least read the breakdown."

Three things the visuals must never do:

- 1. Never show the product before 3:30.** The whole first half earns its credibility by being about *her*, not about a bottle. If a copper bottle appears at 1:00 it becomes an ad and retention dies.
- 2. Never show a smiling person until 4:37.** The one real smile in this film is at the dinner table. If she smiles in the hook the arc is dead on arrival.
- 3. Never show a price, a discount, a badge, or a "limited time" anything.** Value is communicated by the comparison shot at 5:05 (trash bag vs. one bottle) and nothing else.

The four load-bearing images of the whole film — if you only nail four, nail these: **S09** ashwagandha next to her mother's photo · **S14** the empty doorway after "he stopped asking" · **S43** the bare counter with 23 ring-marks in the dust · **S57** the magnet sliding off the copper.

PART 1 — Locks

1.1 Character lock (CHAR_REF)

Use the supplied character sheet as **CHAR_REF** on **every single** person-shot. Non-negotiable.

American woman, ~50–60. Ash/silver-blond shoulder-length hair with a soft natural wave, warm hazel-brown eyes, fine lines at the eyes and mouth, faint sun damage on the cheekbones, no visible makeup, tortoiseshell reading glasses. Warm, tired, credible. Suburban everywoman.

Face rule: identical face in every frame. If a generation drifts the face, kill it — do not "fix it in the grade." Wardrobe changes across the timeline; the face does not.

1.2 Wardrobe states (the timeline lives here)

The film covers ~4 months. Wardrobe is your only clock. Do not mix these up.

Code	When	What
W1 — HOME/NOW	The present-tense telling. Bathroom, kitchen.	Cream chunky-knit cardigan, sage-grey crew tee, dark indigo slim jeans, grey felt slippers, tortoiseshell glasses pushed up on her head
W2 — NIGHT	All bed / 3am / waking beats	Soft heather-grey ribbed sleep tee, hair loose and slept-on, no glasses, bare feet
W3 — TRIP	Airport + sister's house (last May)	Navy quilted zip vest over the sage tee, same jeans, white leather sneakers, tan crossbody bag
W4 — RESEARCH	Desk, labels, late-night reading	W1 but cardigan sleeves pushed to the elbows and glasses on her face , hair tucked behind one ear
W5 — DINNER (Wk 3)	4:37–5:05 only	Soft clay-rust button blouse, no cardigan, hair tucked, small gold studs. Subtly more put-together — the recovery is in the wardrobe before it's in the dialogue

1.3 Locations

Code	Location	Fixed details (keep identical across every shot in that space)
L1	Master bathroom	Cream quartz counter, warm oak vanity, wide mirror, small window with a sheer curtain camera-left, greige tile, chrome faucet. Light always enters from camera-left.
L2	Kitchen	White shaker cabinets, warm oak butcher-block island, farmhouse sink under an east window, brass pulls, one ceramic fruit bowl
L3	Her bedroom	Oatmeal linen bedding, white duvet, walnut nightstand, small brass alarm clock, sheer curtain, grey-green wall
L4	Desk nook	Small walnut desk against a wall, silver laptop, stacked papers, a green banker's-style lamp, the scratched plastic water bottle
L5	Airport, 4am	Empty gate, floor-to-ceiling glass, blue-grey pre-dawn, wet tarmac reflections, one lit newsstand
L6	Sister's house	Warmer, slightly dated: floral wallpaper border, oak cabinets, patterned quilt in the guest room. Must read as <i>not her home</i>
L7	Dining room	Small round table, single warm pendant low over it, two pasta bowls, one glass of red
L8	Hall closet	White wire shelving, folded linens, one flat cardboard box
L9	Archival / hospital	No character. 1890s Swiss lab; modern hospital corridor

1.4 The lighting & grade arc (this is the emotional spine)

Colour does the persuasion. Ride this arc — it should be almost imperceptible shot-to-shot and undeniable across five minutes.

Grade	Blocks	Recipe
GRADE-A	0:00–1:15	Flat, cool-neutral overcast window light. Desaturated. Greenish-grey shadows. Low contrast, lifted blacks. ~5600K. "Clinical fatigue."
GRADE-B	1:15–1:45	Cold blue pre-dawn. ~4300K. Deep crushed shadows, hard sodium-orange accents from terminal signage.
GRADE-C	2:00–2:50	High-contrast task light — one warm pool on the labels, the rest of the room falling to black. ~3000K key against cool ambient. "Investigation."
GRADE-D	2:50–3:30	Amber archival. Tungsten, sepia-leaning browns, copper glints. Slight halation on highlights.
GRADE-E	4:10–4:37	Warmth returns. ~5000K clean morning daylight, gentle saturation lift, shadows open back up.
GRADE-F	4:37–5:45	Honey-warm practical. ~2900K pendant, rich and soft, creamy rolloff. Resolve.

Sister's house (1:45–2:00) is the **first warmth in the film** — a small bump toward E inside GRADE-B. That's deliberate. It's the visual "something changed" before the VO says it.

1.5 Camera language

- **Observational documentary.** The camera is a person in the room who isn't announcing themselves.
- **Lenses:** 35mm for rooms, 50mm for her at mid, 85mm for the intimate face holds, 100mm macro for all labels and product. Never wider than 28mm — no wide-angle face distortion.
- **Height:** eye-level or slightly below. Overhead only for the counter/trash-bag beats.
- **Movement:** micro-drift handheld, slow push, slow rack. **No drone moves, no orbits, no crash zooms, no dutch angles, no lens flares.** Every move should be under 15cm of travel.
- **Depth:** f/2.0 on objects and faces, f/4 on rooms. Let backgrounds go soft — it hides AI artefacts and reads as a real lens.

1.6 Global prompt blocks

Paste these around every shot prompt. Per-shot prompts below contain **only the variables**.

GLOBAL_PREFIX (prepend to every image prompt that contains her):

[ATTACH: CHAR_REF] Photorealistic documentary photograph, vertical 9:16 composition. The woman is identical to the attached reference — same face, same bone structure, same ash-blonde shoulder-length hair, same age, no makeup change, no beautification, no slimming. Candid unposed moment, she is not aware of the camera and never looks into it.

GLOBAL_SUFFIX (append to every image prompt):

Shot on a Sony A7 IV with a prime lens, natural available light only, visible skin texture and pores, fine facial down, faint sensor grain, slightly imperfect handheld framing with the subject a little off-centre, true-to-life colour, no retouching.

NEG (global negative — use in the negative field, or append as "avoid:" for GPT Image):

cartoon, 3D render, CGI, Pixar, illustration, anime, plastic skin, over-smoothed skin, beauty filter, airbrushed, perfect symmetrical teeth, stock-photo smile, model-like, glamour lighting, lens flare, HDR halo, oversaturated, teal-and-orange grade, extra fingers, malformed hands, warped or gibberish text, fake brand logos, watermark, wide-angle face distortion, looking at camera, cinematic letterbox bars, motion blur smear

Model notes: - **Nano Banana Pro** — best for anything with readable text (supplement facts panels, the lab report, the dosage card, the journal page). Spell the exact string you want in quotes. It will hold it. - **GPT Image** — better for the soft emotional face holds and the archival/hospital plates. Trim **GLOBAL_PREFIX** to two sentences for it; it degrades with very long prompts. - Generate **3-4 variants per shot minimum** and cut for face-match first, composition second.

1.7 Real-asset rule (do not skip this)

Never generate the SGS certificate, the verification database screen, or any lab document.

Those are real documents; an AI-fabricated version of a lab certificate is a fabricated record, and it will not survive a compliance look — or a screenshot from a competitor. Same for the product itself.

Shot	Asset	Method
S53, S57, S58, S59, S60, S78, S79	The real copper bottle	Attach the real product photo as a second reference. Prompt as a <i>composite/relight</i> , not a description.
S54, S55	The real SGS certificate	Generate the empty counter/hands plate, comp the real cert page in post.
S56	The public database verification page	Real screen recording on a real phone. Comp into a generated hand-holding-phone plate.
S71	The 30-day guarantee box	Real packaging photo if it exists; otherwise a plain flat-folded kraft box, no printed claim visible.

Everything else in this film is generated.

PART 2 — The flow system (why it won't feel like "scene 1, scene 2, scene 3")

The single biggest thing separating an amateur AI VSL from a winner: **shots don't cut, they hand off**. Every boundary in the list below is assigned one of six handoffs. Build to the handoff, not to the shot.

Code	Handoff	How to build it
MATCH-SHAPE	Shot A ends on a shape, Shot B opens on the same shape	Round bottle cap → round clock face. Both at the same size and screen position.
MATCH-ACTION	A movement starts in A and completes in B	Her hand reaches out of frame right in A; a hand enters frame right in B, same speed.
WHIP-BY	A foreground object crosses the lens and wipes the frame	Her shoulder, a cabinet door, a passing traveller. Cut at maximum blur.
LIGHT-WIPE	A shadow or highlight sweeps the frame and you cut inside it	Curtain moves, headlights sweep a wall, she passes a lamp.
PAN-THROUGH	Camera is moving the same direction on both sides of the cut	A drifts left, B is already drifting left at the same rate. Reads as one continuous move.
FOCUS-HANDOFF	Rack out to blur at the end of A, open on blur and rack in on B	Best for jumps in time or place. The blur is the transition.

Rhythm law: the cut lands on the *breath*, not on the word. Cut a beat **before** the VO finishes the phrase — picture leads audio by ~4 frames. That's what makes it feel edited instead of assembled.

Pacing shape across the film: 2-3s cuts through the stack and the labels (accumulation, pressure) → 4-6s holds on the accident and the transformation (let it breathe) → the two longest holds in the whole film are **S14** (empty doorway) and **S69** (she cries into her pasta). Silence and stillness are the premium moments; you've earned them by then.

PART 3 — Deliverables checklist

- [] **01-HOOK-A.md** — H1 swap-test hook, 7 shots
- [] **02-HOOK-B.md** — H2 swap-test hook, 6 shots
- [] **03-BODY.md** — S01-S80, the shared VSL body
- [] Real product photos supplied as second reference on all product shots
- [] Real SGS cert + real verification screen recording comped, never generated
- [] Face-match QC pass across all 93 shots before assembly
- [] Music: soft indie-folk, ~80 BPM — sparse under the stack, swell at 4:43, resolve on CTA
- [] CTA card → Page 1 (Dr. Chen advertorial)